“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 6

The Divine Majesty of Śrī Advaita Ācārya

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 I worship Śrī Advaita Ācārya, whose deeds are wonderful. By His mercy even an ignorant person can describe His true nature.

2 All glory, all glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaita-candra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 In five verses I have told the truth about Śrī Nityānanda. Now in two verses I tell the greatness of Advaita Ācārya.

4 Mahā-Viṣṇu, the creator of the world, creates this universe through His energy, māyā. The Lord Advaita Ācārya is His very avatāra.

5 He is called Advaita because He is non-different from Hari, and Ācārya because He proclaims devotion (*bhakti*). I take shelter of that Lord, Advaita Ācārya, who descended as a devotee.

6 Advaita Ācārya is the Lord Himself. His greatness lies beyond the grasp of the living being (*jīva*).

7 Mahā-Viṣṇu carries out the creation of the world and all the other works of the cosmos. Advaita Ācārya is His direct avatāra.

8 That Puruṣa creates and maintains the world through māyā. He creates unlimited universes in play (*līlā*).

9 By His will He manifests unlimited forms, and in a separate form He enters each universe.

10 Advaita is a portion of that Puruṣa, and there is no difference at all between Them. He is a particular body of the Puruṣa, never separate from Him.

11 He assists the Puruṣa by taking up the *pradhāna*, and by His will He fashions millions of universes.

12 Advaita is the good of the whole world, the abode of all auspicious qualities. His conduct is always auspicious, and auspiciousness itself is His name.

13 Taking millions of portions, millions of energies and millions of avatāras, the Puruṣa creates the whole world.

14 Māyā has two aspects, the efficient cause (*nimitta*) and the material cause (*upādāna*). Māyā is the efficient cause, and the *pradhāna* is the material cause.

15 In the same way the Lord, the Puruṣa, assumes two forms and creates the universe through the efficient and the material cause.

16 The Puruṣa Himself is the efficient cause of the world, and in the form of Advaita, Nārāyaṇa becomes the material cause.

17 As the efficient aspect, He glances at māyā; as the material cause, Advaita creates the universes.

18 Although the Sāṅkhya philosophy holds that the *pradhāna* is the cause, the world can never come into being from inert matter.

19 The Lord infuses His own creative power into the *pradhāna*, and only then, by the Lord's power, does creation take place.

20 Advaita Ācārya is the creator of millions of universes, and in a separate form He maintains each universe.

21 Advaita is the principal limb (*aṅga*) of that Nārāyaṇa. The *Bhāgavatam* uses the word *aṅga* in the sense of *aṁśa*, a portion.

22 “O Lord, are You not Nārāyaṇa? You are the Self of all embodied beings and the witness of all the worlds. The one called Nārāyaṇa because His resting place is the water born of Nara is Your portion. And that portion too is real; it is not Your māyā.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.14.14)

23 This verse says that the Lord's limbs and portions are full of consciousness and bliss and have no connection with māyā.

24 Why call Him an *aṅga*, a limb, rather than an *aṁśa*, a portion? Because the word *aṅga* expresses greater intimacy than *aṁśa*.

25 Advaita, the abode of all good qualities, is a portion of Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is non-different from the Lord, and so His full name is Advaita, “non-dual.”

26 Just as He once created the entire universe, so now He has descended and established the path of devotion.

27 He delivered the souls by giving them devotion to Kṛṣṇa, and He explained the *Bhagavad-gītā* and the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* in the light of bhakti.

28 He has no work other than teaching bhakti; therefore His name became Advaita Ācārya.

29 He is the guru of the Vaiṣṇavas and the most honored person in the world. The union of the two names became “Advaita Ācārya.”

30 Because He is a limb and portion of the lotus-eyed Lord, He is called Kamalākṣa, “the lotus-eyed,” and He wears that name like a crest jewel.

31 The Lord's associates attain a form like His own (*sārūpya*): like Nārāyaṇa, they are four-armed and dressed in yellow.

32 Advaita Ācārya is the foremost portion of the Lord. His truth, His name and His qualities are all wonderful.

33 By His offerings of tulasī and water and by His roaring calls, Śrī Caitanya descended together with His associates.

34 Through Him the Lord spread the kīrtana, and through Him the Lord delivered the world.

35 The qualities and greatness of Advaita Ācārya are boundless. How could a soul, a mere worm, ever find their limit?

36 Advaita Ācārya is the principal limb of Śrī Caitanya, and Lord Nityānanda is His other limb.

37 The Lord's sub-limbs (*upāṅgas*) are Śrīvāsa and the other devotees. They are like His hands, face, eyes and other limbs, and like His disc and other weapons.

38 With all of them Śrī Caitanya performs His pastimes, and with all of them He spreads what He desires to give.

39 Knowing that Advaita is a disciple of Mādhavendra Purī, the Lord regards Him as His guru.

40 In His humanlike pastimes He keeps the bounds of dharma, and with praise and devotion He worships Advaita's feet.

41 Advaita Ācārya, however, regards Śrī Caitanya as His Master (*prabhu*) and thinks of Himself as His servant (*dāsa*).

42 In the joy of that self-conception He forgets Himself and teaches all souls: “Become servants of Kṛṣṇa!”

43 Such is the ocean of bliss in thinking oneself Kṛṣṇa's servant that the happiness of Brahman, multiplied ten million times, does not equal one drop of it.

44 [Advaita says:] “I am a servant of Caitanya, and so is Nityānanda.” Nowhere is there bliss equal to the mood of a servant.

45 Lakṣmī, the Lord's most beloved, dwells on His chest, yet she too humbly begs for the happiness of serving Him.

46 All the Lord's associates are blissful in the mood of service: Brahmā, Śiva, Nārada, Śuka, Sanātana Kumāra and others.

47 Nityānanda Avadhūta, foremost among them all, became mad with love in the service of Śrī Caitanya.

48–49 Śrīvāsa, Haridāsa, Rāmadāsa, Gadādhara, Murāri, Mukunda, Candraśekhara and Vakreśvara are learned men of the highest greatness, yet service to Śrī Caitanya makes them all mad with love.

50 So they sing, dance and laugh aloud, and they teach everyone: “Become servants of Śrī Caitanya!”

51 [Advaita thinks:] “Śrī Caitanya regards Me as His guru, yet I still feel Myself to be His servant.”

52 This is one unprecedented power of love for Kṛṣṇa: it gives the mood of a servant to elders, equals and juniors alike.

53 Hear the proof of this in the explanation of the scriptures, where the experience of great souls stands as firm proof.

54–55 What to speak of others? In Vraja no one is so much Kṛṣṇa's elder (*guru*) as the noble Nanda. In his pure parental love (*vātsalya*) he has no awareness that Kṛṣṇa is God, yet love moves even him to take on the mood of a servant.

56 He too prays for love and devotion at Kṛṣṇa's feet, and the words from his own lips prove it.

57–58 “Listen, Uddhava: truly, Kṛṣṇa is my son. If you think He is God, so be it. Still, may every movement of my mind rest on Him, and may my heart be fixed on Kṛṣṇa, your God.”

59 “May our minds take shelter of Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, may our words speak His names, and may our bodies bow down to Him and serve Him.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.47.66)

60 “Wherever we may wander by the Lord's will, driven by our karma, may our good deeds and our gifts bring us love for Kṛṣṇa, the Lord.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.47.67)

61 In Vraja, Śrīdāmā and all of Kṛṣṇa's other friends know nothing of His majesty; they are filled with pure friendship (*sakhya*).

62 They wrestle with Kṛṣṇa and climb onto His shoulders, yet in the mood of servants they serve His feet.

63 “Some massaged the feet of the great-hearted Lord, and others, whose sins had been destroyed, fanned Him with fans.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.15.17)

64–65 Kṛṣṇa's beloveds in Vraja, the gopīs, the dust of whose feet Uddhava prays for and than whom no one is dearer to Kṛṣṇa, think of themselves as His maidservants.

66 “O You who take away the suffering of the people of Vraja! O hero of women, whose smile destroys the pride of Your own people! O friend, accept us, Your maidservants, and show us Your lovely lotus face.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.31.6)

67 “Alas, does the son of the noble Nanda now live in Madhupurī? O gentle one, does He remember His father's home, His friends and the cowherds? Does He ever speak of us, His maidservants? When will He place on our heads His arm, fragrant with aguru?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.47.21)

68–69 Let alone the other gopīs: Śrīmatī Rādhikā, who surpasses them all in every respect and whose love and virtues keep Kṛṣṇa bound at every moment, serves His feet as His maidservant.

70 “O Master! O Lover! O Dearest! Where are You, where are You, O mighty-armed one? O friend, show Yourself to Me, Your wretched maidservant!” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.30.39)

71 In Dvārakā, Rukmiṇī and all the other queens also consider themselves Kṛṣṇa's maidservants.

72 “Knowing that I was performing austerities in the hope of touching His feet, He came with His friend Arjuna and took my hand. I am that same woman, the one who sweeps His house.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.83.11)

73 “By giving up all attachments and by austerity, we have become the housemaids of Him who delights in Himself.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.83.39)

74 What to speak of others? Consider the great Baladeva, whose mood is full of pure friendship, parental affection and the like.

75 Even He thinks of Himself as a servant. Who is there without the mood of a servant of Kṛṣṇa?

76 Śeṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa, who has a thousand mouths, assumes ten bodies to serve Kṛṣṇa.

77 In the unlimited universes Rudra is a portion of Sadāśiva. He is the *guṇa-avatāra* and the crown of all the gods.

78 He too longs to serve Kṛṣṇa. Śiva constantly says, “I am Kṛṣṇa's servant.”

79 Mad with love for Kṛṣṇa, overwhelmed and unclothed, he constantly sings of Kṛṣṇa's qualities and pastimes and dances.

80 Whether one's mood is that of a father, a mother, an elder or a friend, love for Kṛṣṇa by its very nature produces the mood of a servant.

81 Kṛṣṇa alone is the Lord of the world, the one whom all serve. All others are His servants and followers.

82 That same Kṛṣṇa has descended as Lord Caitanya; therefore all others are His servants.

83 Some accept this and some do not, but all are His servants. One who does not accept it is ruined by that very sin.

84 [Advaita says:] “I am Caitanya's servant, Caitanya's servant! I am Caitanya's servant, the servant of His servants!”

85 Saying this, He dances and sings with deep roars; then, a moment later, the Ācārya grows calm and sits down.

86 The root of the self-conception of a devotee is in Śrī Balarāma, and all His portions follow that mood.

87 One of His avatāras, Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa, always thinks of Himself as a devotee.

88 Another of His avatāras, the glorious Lakṣmaṇa, served Śrī Rāma at every moment.

89 The Lord who lies in the Causal Ocean is an avatāra of Saṅkarṣaṇa, and accordingly the mood of a devotee fills His heart too.

90 Advaita Ācārya is a distinct manifestation of Him, and devotion with body, mind and words is always His work.

91 In words He says, “I am Caitanya's follower,” and in His mind He constantly thinks, “I am His devotee.”

92 With His body He serves by offering water and tulasī, and by preaching bhakti He delivered the whole world.

93 Śeṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa, who holds up the earth, expands into many bodies (*kāya-vyūha*) to serve Kṛṣṇa.

94 All of these are avatāras of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, yet we always see Them behave as devotees.

95 Scripture calls Them all avatāras as devotees (*bhakta-avatāras*), and the position of an avatāra as a devotee is above all others.

96 Kṛṣṇa alone is the source of all portions (*aṁśī*), and the avatāras are His portions (*aṁśas*). Between the source and the portion we see the conduct of elder and younger.

97 Seeing the source as the elder, the portion regards Him as Master; seeing Himself as the younger, He thinks of Himself as a devotee.

98 The position of a devotee is greater than equality with Kṛṣṇa, for Kṛṣṇa loves His devotee more than His own self.

99 Kṛṣṇa considers His devotee greater than Himself, and many statements of scripture testify to this.

100 “Neither Brahmā, who was born from Me, nor Śaṅkara, nor Saṅkarṣaṇa, nor Śrī, nor even My own self is as dear to Me as you are.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.14.15)

101 In equality with Kṛṣṇa there is no tasting of His sweetness; it is in the mood of a devotee that one relishes it.

102 This is the conclusion of scripture and the experience of the wise. Foolish people do not know the glory of this mood.

103–104 Accepting the mood of devotees, Balarāma, Lakṣmaṇa, Advaita, Nityānanda, Śeṣa and Saṅkarṣaṇa drink the nectar of the rasa of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness. Intoxicated with that joy, They know nothing else.

105 Let alone others: Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself became thirsty to drink His own sweetness.

106 He strives to taste His own sweetness, but without the mood of a devotee it cannot be tasted.

107 So, accepting the mood of a devotee, He descended as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, complete in every mood.

108 In the various moods of devotees He drinks His own sweetness. I have explained this conclusion before.

109 The avatāras have a claim to the mood of a devotee, for there is no happiness greater than the mood of a devotee.

110 Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original avatāra as a devotee, and Advaita is counted among the avatāras as devotees.

111 The greatness of Advaita Ācārya is boundless: His roaring call brought about the descent of Śrī Caitanya.

112 By spreading *saṅkīrtana* He delivered the whole world. By Advaita's mercy people obtained the treasure of love.

113 Who can tell Advaita's unlimited greatness? I write only what I have heard from great souls (*mahājanas*).

114 Ten million obeisances at the Ācārya's feet! May He not count any offense of mine in this.

115 Your greatness is unfathomable, like ten million oceans. To speak of its measure is a great offense.

116 All glory, all glory to Śrī Advaita Ācārya! All glory to Śrī Caitanya and to the noble Nityānanda!

117 In two verses I have described the truth about Advaita. Now, O devotees, hear a little about the Pañca-tattva.

118 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, tell the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.